

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐UNUSUAL RECORD ☒

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: Cerulean Warbler | Dendroica cerulea
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date: Labor Day September 4, 1989Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: Female Plumage: Breeding AdultLocality: Below Two Buttes Reservoir (downstream) next to road about 700 feet west of first parking spot and old concrete outhouse. Elevation: 4225' ±Nearest town: 16 miles NNE from Springfield County: BacaTime observed: about 8:45 AMDuration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): 3 minutes

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

~~Other Name~~ Found by Randy Lentz, Bill Howe (Records Committee), DFO
Glenn & Jeanne Hagerman, Alan & Dee Hay, Jean Maguire, Joe Ten Brink } Labor-Day
and Pat Snider & Joyce Takamine from Los Alamos, New Mexico } Weekend

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers)

None

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

Excellent - Sun at our backsOptical equipment used (e.g. power, types): 8x36 Bushnell binocularsDistance, and how measured: 50-100' estimatedIf photographed, type of equipment and film: NoWho else photographed the bird? No One

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

When I first saw the bird it had flown down on the ground beside the road so I could see the top of the head and back. Then it flew 20' up in an open cottonwood and gradually feathered up the tree to 40' up.

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observe in the field:

Small warbler size. The pale green on the upper back and top of head was striking. Occasionally a bluish cast could be seen in the green on top of the head. Two prominent white wing bar on what appeared to me to be nearly black wings and lower back and upper tail with no streaking. When the bird flew up in the tree the yellow throat and breast were prominent. OVER

Description (continued):

The streaking on the sides of the breast was noticeable but faint. The yellow extended farther down the breast than shown for the female in the National Geographic. I did not notice the eyeline but others were talking about it.

There was no dissent, and no one thought it was some other bird. Everyone saw it well.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration):

No sound of any kind.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

Riparian bushes and trees along Two Butte Creek near two pools of water below Two Butte Reservoir. Many birds had crowded into this sunny spot which was sheltered from a light breeze.

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

The only other warbler with wing-bars that has light green above is an immature and fall-plumaged Chestnut-sided Warbler. The green in this bird was darker and had a bluish caste on the top of the head. The Chestnut-sided does not have a yellow throat + breast. A female Painted Bunting does not have wing bars. NWR

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I have seen only 1 male Cerulean Warbler at Laguna Atascosa, Texas in the spring. I have never seen a female but there was no mistaking this bird.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

- a) at time of observation: None - I was certain it had to be a Cerulean.
- b) after observation: ~~During~~ After write-up National Geographic N.A. Birds
Golden Guide " "

This report was written from reports made during _____, after observation _____ from memory X
Date and time report was written: 1 PM September 6, 1989

Reporting observer: Dan Bridger Signature: T. W. Dan Bridger

Address: 1925 S. Vaughn Way #207 Aurora, Colorado 80014

All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below:

Return to:

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